Annual Business Report

Desert Sun Consulting · Unit 2 — Word Processing · Core Project · 100 points · 31 tasks

How to use this instruction sheet. Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool — but you figure out the exact steps yourself. That's the learning. When you're done, save the file and upload it to the Core 1 grader for instant scoring.

D1 — Manage Documents

22 points · 8 tasks

Task 1 — Set 1-inch margins on all sides

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Professional documents use consistent margins so text doesn't crowd the edges. 1-inch margins are the standard for business reports.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Margins → Normal (or Custom Margins and enter 1" on all four sides).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The white space around your text looks even on all four sides; the ruler shows the boundary at the 1-inch mark.

Task 2 — Set page orientation to Portrait

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Portrait orientation (taller than wide) is standard for business reports. The Financial Summary section will use Landscape — that is a separate task.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Layout tab → Page Setup group → Orientation → Portrait.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your pages are taller than they are wide (standard 8.5" × 11").

Task 3 — Apply the “Basic (Stylish)” style set to the entire document

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Style sets change the fonts and colors of all built-in styles (Title, Heading 1, etc.) at once, giving the document a consistent professional look.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Document Formatting group → Style Sets gallery → Basic (Stylish).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The document's heading fonts and colors change; “Basic (Stylish)” appears when you hover the chosen thumbnail.

Task 4 — Insert a header with the company name and the date

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Headers appear on every page and help readers identify the document and track when it was created.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Header & Footer group → Header → Edit Header. Type “Desert Sun Consulting,” then add the date (Insert → Date & Time).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page shows the company name and the date in the header.

Task 5 — Insert a footer with “Confidential” centered

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A confidentiality notice in the footer protects sensitive business information and appears on every printed page.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Header & Footer group → Footer → Edit Footer. Center the text and type “Confidential”.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page shows “Confidential” centered in the footer.

Task 6 — Insert page numbers in the bottom-right corner

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Page numbers help readers navigate a multi-page document and are expected in professional business reports.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Header & Footer tab → Page Number → Bottom of Page → a right-aligned option (Plain Number 3).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each page shows its page number in the bottom-right corner.

Task 7 — Add a “DRAFT” watermark to all pages

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A watermark visually communicates that the document is not the final version, preventing premature distribution.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Watermark → DRAFT 1 (or Custom Watermark).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The word “DRAFT” appears diagonally in light gray behind the content on every page.

Task 8 — Set document properties: Title and Author

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Document properties embed metadata that helps identify files in shared folders and appears in search results.

WHERE TO FIND IT

File tab → Info → Properties panel on the right. Set Title (e.g. “Annual Business Report 2026”) and Author (“Desert Sun Consulting”).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

File → Info shows the correct Title and Author in the Properties panel.

D2 — Format Text & Paragraphs

22 points · 7 tasks

Task 9 — Use Find & Replace to change every “DSC” to “Desert Sun Consulting”

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

The starter file uses the abbreviation “DSC” throughout. A professional report should use the full company name, and Find & Replace does this in seconds.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Home tab → Editing group → Replace (Ctrl+H). Find “DSC”, Replace with “Desert Sun Consulting”, Replace All.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A message reports the number of replacements; searching for “DSC” finds nothing afterward.

Task 10 — Apply the Title style to the document's main title

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

The Title style is a built-in style that formats the document's main heading and can be referenced by the Table of Contents.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the main title on the cover page → Home tab → Styles group → Title.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The title text changes to a large, distinctive font that differs from the body text.

Task 11 — Apply Heading 1 to every major section header

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 1 creates the top-level structure of your document and is required for the Table of Contents to build automatically.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click a section header → Home tab → Styles group → Heading 1. Repeat for every section header (Format Painter speeds this up).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

All section headers share a consistent larger, colored font and appear as top-level items in the Navigation Pane.

Task 12 — Apply Heading 2 to every subsection header

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Heading 2 creates the second level of your document hierarchy, appearing indented under Heading 1 items in the Table of Contents.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click a subsection header → Home tab → Styles group → Heading 2. Repeat for all subsection headers.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Subsection headers appear in a distinct format from Heading 1 and are indented in the Navigation Pane.

Task 13 — Set body text line spacing to 1.15

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

1.15 line spacing improves readability by adding a small gap between lines without taking up as much space as double spacing.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the body text → Home tab → Paragraph group → Line and Paragraph Spacing → 1.15.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Body text lines have a small but noticeable gap; the Paragraph dialog shows 1.15 in Line spacing.

Task 14 — Set 6pt spacing after each paragraph

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Spacing after paragraphs creates visual separation between ideas without extra blank lines, which is the professional standard.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the text → Layout tab → Paragraph group → set “After” to 6 pt.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

There is a visible gap after each paragraph; the Layout tab shows “6 pt” in the After field.

Task 15 — Insert a section break before Financial Summary and change that section to Landscape

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A section break lets you apply different page settings to one part of a document. The Financial Summary table is wide and needs Landscape to fit. (Everything after the break becomes Landscape — that is expected.)

WHERE TO FIND IT

Place the cursor just before the Financial Summary heading → Layout tab → Breaks → Next Page. Then click in that section → Layout → Orientation → Landscape.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The Financial Summary section appears on Landscape page(s) while the earlier pages remain Portrait.

D3 — Tables & Lists

18 points · 6 tasks

Task 16 — Create a 4-column table for the quarterly revenue data

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Tables organize data into rows and columns, making financial figures much easier to compare than plain paragraphs.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Tables group → Table → select a 4-column grid (about 4×5).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A 4-column table appears; you can click any cell and type.

Task 17 — Merge the top row cells into a single spanning title

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Merging the header row lets you add a centered title that spans the entire table width.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all cells in row 1 → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Merge Cells.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Row 1 becomes one wide cell instead of four; a title can span the full width.

Task 18 — Sort the client table alphabetically

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Alphabetical sorting makes tables easier to scan, especially for long client lists.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the client table → Table Layout tab → Data group → Sort → choose the name column → Ascending.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The rows are now in A-to-Z order by client name.

Task 19 — Create a numbered list of the 5 strategic objectives

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Numbered lists show sequence or ranking, making ordered information easier to follow than plain paragraphs.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Type each objective on its own line, select all 5 → Home tab → Paragraph group → Numbering.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each objective is automatically numbered 1 through 5.

Task 20 — Create a bulleted list of services offered

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Bulleted lists organize non-sequential items visually.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Type each service on its own line, select them → Home tab → Paragraph group → Bullets.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each service has a bullet (•).

Task 21 — Increase the list level for the sub-items

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Increasing the list level (indenting) creates a visual hierarchy showing which items are subordinate.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the sub-item lines → Home tab → Paragraph group → Increase Indent (or press Tab at the start of the line).

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Sub-items are indented further right than the main items, often with a different bullet symbol.

D4 — References

10 points · 3 tasks

Task 22 — Insert an automatic Table of Contents after the title page

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

An automatic TOC uses your Heading styles to build a clickable list of sections with page numbers that updates as content changes.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Place the cursor on a blank page after the cover page → References tab → Table of Contents → an Automatic style.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A Table of Contents appears listing your headings with page numbers.

Task 23 — Customize the Table of Contents to show only Heading 1 and Heading 2

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Showing only two heading levels keeps the TOC concise; a 3-level TOC can become cluttered in a business report.

WHERE TO FIND IT

References tab → Table of Contents → Custom Table of Contents → set “Show levels” to 2 → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The TOC shows only Heading 1 and Heading 2 items.

Task 24 — Insert a footnote on the revenue figure that cites the data source

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Footnotes credit data sources and add credibility to financial figures without cluttering the main text.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click immediately after the revenue figure → References tab → Footnotes group → Insert Footnote → type the citation.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A superscript number appears after the figure and the matching footnote text appears at the bottom of the page.

D5 — Graphic Elements

19 points · 4 tasks

Task 25 — Insert the DSC logo image on the cover page

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

A company logo on the cover page establishes brand identity and gives the report a polished, professional appearance.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Pictures → This Device → select the logo file. Position it on the cover page.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The logo appears on the cover page.

Task 26 — Set text wrapping to “Through” for the logo

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Text wrapping controls how surrounding text flows around an image. “Through” lets text wrap around the image's shape.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the logo → Picture Format tab → Arrange group → Wrap Text → Through.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Text flows around the logo rather than leaving a rectangular empty space.

Task 27 — Insert a text box with the report tagline on the cover page

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Text boxes let you place text anywhere on the page independently of the normal text flow — useful for taglines and callouts.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Text group → Text Box → Draw Text Box → drag on the cover page → type the tagline.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A text box containing the tagline appears on the cover page and can be dragged independently.

Task 28 — Add descriptive alt text to EVERY image in the document

8 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Alt text describes images to screen-reader users who cannot see visual content. It is required for ADA compliance and accessibility standards.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Right-click each image → Edit Alt Text → type a clear description. Do this for every image.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Right-clicking any image shows your description in the Alt Text pane.

D6 — Collaboration

9 points · 3 tasks

Task 29 — Add a comment on the revenue figure requesting verification

3 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Comments let collaborators ask questions or flag items without changing the document content.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the revenue figure → Review tab → Comments group → New Comment → type your verification request.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A comment bubble appears in the right margin connected to the revenue figure.

Task 30 — Reply to the existing comment in the document

2 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Replying to comments creates a conversation thread, which is how teams collaborate on documents professionally.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click the existing comment in the sidebar → Reply → type your reply.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your reply appears indented below the original comment as a thread.

Task 31 — Enable Track Changes and make 3 edits to the Executive Summary

4 pt

WHY THIS MATTERS

Track Changes records every edit — who made it and when — so collaborators can review, accept, or reject each change.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Review tab → Tracking group → Track Changes (toggle on) → make 3 edits to the Executive Summary.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Your edits appear in a different color with underline (insertions) or strikethrough (deletions).

Total: 100 points · 31 tasks. Every task on this sheet is graded automatically when you upload your file. © Dr. Mark Taormino